

SOUND IT OUT

[Inspired by Heather's memo on literacy]

ad lib blues guitar intro

Lyrics by Ajay Agrawal, Chart by Tom Benke ©2026

||E7#9 ///| ///| ///| ///| ///| ///| ///| ///|

(hey!)

Verse 1

I was born_ into a country, with a story half untold,

D5

A5

With a cradle full of promise and a winter full of cold.

E5

Father read The Hockey Sweater mother read Blue Sky

D5

A5

|Em7 ///| ///|

Said, "E-v'ry little letter is a door__ you open wide."

Verse 2

There's a classroom by the highway where the mornin' light comes in,

D

A

Twenty-seven pairs of sneakers twenty-seven ways to begin.

Em7

Some runnin' thru sentences, some stranded at the sound,

D

A

Some waitin' for the grown-ups to turn the thing around.

Chorus

Sound it out, sound it out, In a whisper in a shout Nothin' comes for free No matter, Chat GPT

E

G

D

A

E

G

D

A

Hold the line, pass it down Need books whe-re hope runs out.

E

G

D

A

C

D N.C.

|Em7 ///|

///

/

| ///|

///...

For a nation with a future, We got to sound it out

We gotta sound it out

Verse 3

N.C. Em7

Don't tell me it's a mystery, don't tell me it's too late,

D

A

Don't hang a child's tomorrow on a postal code or fate.

Em7

There are ladders made of syllables, there are bridges made o' rhyme,

D

A

There are teachers who can build them if we give them tools and time.

Verse 4

Em7

So read it in the kitchen read it waitin' for the bus.

D

A

Read it like a love note from the future back to us.

Em7

Read the fox and read the moonrise read the sign above the store,

D

A N.C.

Till the world is not a lock box but a room with open doors.

Chorus

E G D A E G D A
Sound it out, sound it out, (oo!) In a whisper in a shout Nothin' comes for free No matter, Chat GPT
 E G D A
Hold the line, pass it down Need books whe-re hope runs out.
 C D N.C. |Em7 ///| ///|
 For a nation with a future, We got to sound it out (woo!)

Bridge

Em G6 A E G6 A E
 A.I.s will spin their gold, With answers clean and cold, But facts have no soul The reader makes it so
 G6 A E
 All that we see or seem Is but a dream within a dream
 N.C. G6 D A
 Your scratch your spark your, crooked line. Proof you were here. in space and time.

Final Chorus

E N.C. D A E N.C. D N.C.
Sound it out, sound it out, (hey!) In a whisper in a shout Nothin' comes for free No matter, Chat GPT
 E G D A
Hold the line, pass it down Need books whe-re hope runs out.
 C D N.C. |E ///| ///| / | ///| ///|
 For a nation, with a future, hey-y_ We got to sound it out We gotta sound it out
 | ///| / ||

E7#9	07678X
D5	X577XX
A5	X022XX
E5	022XXX
Em7	022030
D	XX0232
A	X02220
E	022100
G	320003
Em	022000
G6	320000
N.C.	No Chord